

# Potentials of Technology

**H**undreds of books and articles address technological change and make predictions. What is usually missing is an explanation of the constraints placed on technological development by the social system in which it occurs.

Today, financial barriers place enormous limitations on the innovation, individual creativity, and incentives, which have the potential to liberate humanity from its most pressing problems. Our existing economic and political structures are no longer able to keep up with changes in technology. Profit, secrecy, and competition hinder its implementation.

We are at a time when the methods of science and technology can provide abundance for all if managed intelligently. It is no longer necessary to consciously withhold efficiency through planned obsolescence and artificial scarcity. Continuing our old monetary system promotes these practices. In our high-energy civilization, rationing resources through monetary manipulation is no longer relevant, but is counter-productive to our survival.

With computers processing trillions of bits of information per second existing technologies far exceed human capacity for making reasonable decisions about the development and distribution of resources. With this processing potential we can surpass the practice of decisions being made on the basis of power and advantage.

Soon most will realize that a cybernated society can benefit humanity more than any other development in history. Here we do not contemplate the use of technology to advance the interests of transnational corporations, but rather to organize a global economy based on human rights and basic needs.

All people, regardless of race, color, or creed, need clean air and water, food, shelter, medical care, and education. Supplying these needs is a technical problem, not a political one.

The Venus Project's solution, a resource-based economy, uses the methods of science to arrive at a sustainable future. All resources are available to everyone without money, barter, credit, debt, or servitude of any kind. Within a resource-based economy,

all resources are the common heritage of all people.

This can be achieved with technology and cybernetics if they're used with human and environmental concern to secure, protect, and develop a more humane world for everyone.

To achieve this we must first survey and inventory what we have to work with, namely the resources, technical personnel, manufacturing plants, and the needs of people. Our plans must be doable within the carrying capacity of Earth's resources.

While many urban centers grapple with retrofitting new and more efficient tech-



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nologies into existing infrastructures, these efforts fall short of the potentials of technology. We must rebuild our physical infrastructures using total city system designs. Industrial plants, waterways, power systems, production and distribution processes, and transportation systems must be reconstructed from the ground up with a total global-systems approach. Only then can technology overcome resource deficiencies and provide universal abundance.

Automated control could happen using sensors to monitor the earth's resources from every conceivable location. These could be linked together using a worldwide network of computers. Instead of policing human behavior, these monitors would help us arrive at the most appropriate decisions for humans and the environment. Monitoring personal behavior will be neither necessary nor desirable within a global resource-based economy since everyone will have access to the necessities of life.

If technology were managed intelligently with human and environmental concern, it could overcome scarcity and liberate millions of humans from poverty, hunger, crime, and war. There would then be no limit to human potential.

One purpose of this technology is to free people from dangerous, repetitive, and boring jobs, and allow them to experience the fullness of human relationships, denied to so many for so long. This calls for a basic adjustment in how we think about what it means to be civilized.

Do we have the capacity, the will, and the intelligence to clearly think through and implement changes for our overall benefit, or must we wait for some catastrophic event to direct our future? 



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Mr. Fresco's background includes industrial design and social engineering, as well as being a forerunner in the field of Human Factors. Mr. Fresco has worked as both designer and inventor in a wide range of fields spanning from biomedical innovations to totally integrated social systems.

He has authored books such as *Introduction to Sociocyberneering*, *The Venus Project: The Redesign of a Culture*, *Designing the Future*. He has also produced and filmed *The Venus Project*, *Cities in the Sea*, *Designing the Future*.